



ShabbaTTogether

Shabbat Inclusive Kids Program Ideas

Goals:

Inclusive programs for children on Shabbat

Target Audience:

Ages 3-12

Time:

1 hour

Medium:

In Person Only

Note to Facilitator:

Shabbos is a time of the week where family and community convene. Typically viewed as a joyous and sociable time, for a child with a developmental disability and his or her family, it can be a challenging time. It is a time of increased behavioral and social expectations that may be difficult, such as sitting for a long time in shul, participating in a shul's children's program or in a formal meal.

According to the CDC, one in seven children has a developmental delay. Chances are, you have one or more children in your shul whose daily challenges have been given a diagnosis. This resource has a variety of techniques commonly used in the special education world to help children participate in group activities. It also has inclusive games and snack crafts.

There is a two-fold goal in the resources:

1. Promote the concept of inclusion - which is part of a general Ahavas Yisroel concept - among children.
2. Provide strategies that may help children with challenges to be successful in the shul children's program.

This Guide includes:

1. Ideas to help children acclimate and participate in the children's program



ShabbaTTogether

2. Inclusive Snack Crafts
3. Inclusion Activities

1. Helping Children Acclimate and Participate

- A. Visual Schedules are particularly helpful for children who are new to a situation, or those who have anxiety or difficulty with transitions. They are also enjoyed by all children - everyone likes to know what's going on!
- B. [Click HERE to download this Print-Ready Visual Schedule -->](#)
- C. Build group rapport and an inclusive vibe with ideas from [Five Ways to Create an Inclusive Environment](#).

2. Inclusive Snack Craft

[Click here for two inclusive themed snack crafts.](#)

3. Inclusion Activities

Games are a way for children to have fun and build social skills and connections. They can also be a great learning tool! Books provide stories, imagination and are a great way to begin a discussion.

These activities are designed with meeting the needs of a wide range of abilities and ages. Choose which activities will work for your group of children, and adapt for your group.

This resource has three sections:

1. Inclusion themed games
2. Book based discussions

Inclusion themed games

1. The Same Game (Based on game from Emma Sharp, Friendship Circle Sydney)

Ages: 5 -12 years old

Materials: None

Directions: Put the chairs in a circle and have one child stand in the middle and share something with the other children, for example, "I have two sisters". Every other child





ShabbaTTogether

who has two sisters now must quickly get up from their chairs and swap seats with another child. Whoever is left standing goes next, "I have one brother...." etc.

Here are some prompts to help the children:

- ▶ Favorite color
- ▶ Favorite food
- ▶ Favorite animal
- ▶ School
- ▶ Age
- ▶ Siblings

Reflections after the game:

Who had something the same as someone else?

How does it feel to have the same thing as someone else?

Do you think we can have the same thing as someone else with everyone?

2. Shabbat Together Bingo

Ages: 3 years and older

Materials: [Click HERE to download Bingo Board-->](#)
Small items for children to cover their boards

during play

Prizes (optional)

Directions: Bingo is a popular game with many age groups. It is a structured activity, and has built in reinforcers. As the children play, encourage them to be happy for the winners, whoever wins, and to enjoy the process. Make the game even more interactive by singing a song related to a card that was just chosen. Adjust the level of play according to your group and individual needs:

1. Pick up a picture and say what it is.
2. Pick up a picture and have the kids say what it is.
3. Have a child pick up a picture and say what it is.
4. Pick up a picture and give a clue. I.e: "This is something we eat on Shabbat."





ShabbaTTogether

Book Based Discussions

1. *We can Find a Way* by Dina Rosenfeld, published by Hachai
 - a. This book has a family find solutions so that everyone can attend and be happy at Bubby's Birthday!
<https://www.amazon.com/Can-Find-Way-Hachnosas-inclusion/dp/1945560150>
2. *Just Ask!*
 - a. This book links a garden concept and the concept that all our differences make us unique. Perfect for Tu B'Shvat, or Shabbos Shira.
<https://www.amazon.com/Just-Ask-Different-Brave-You/dp/0525514120>